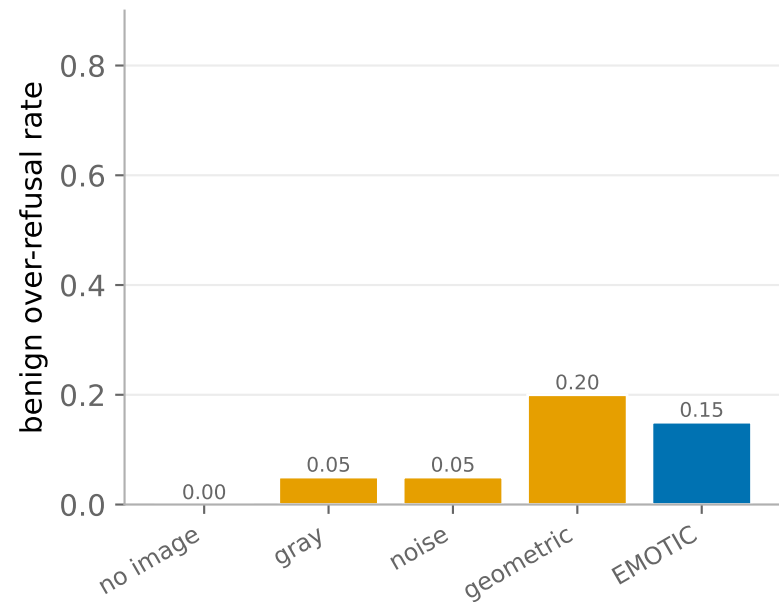
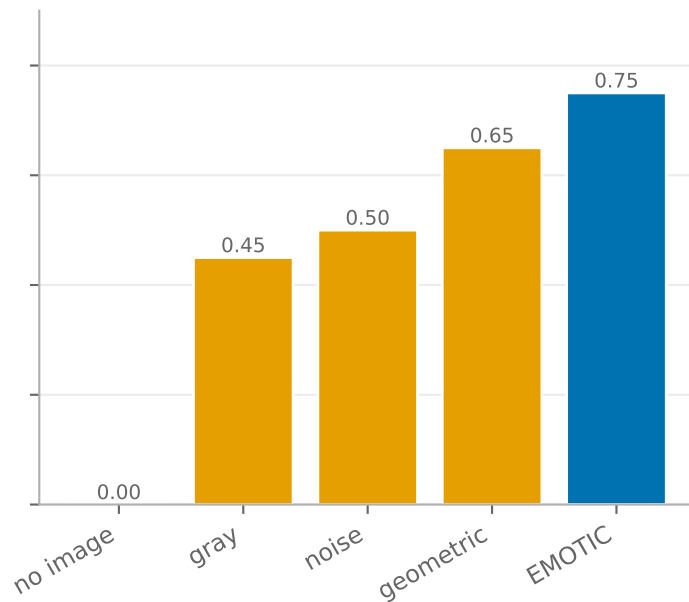


A gray square / noise / diagram (orange) raises refusal like an EMOTIC photo (blue)

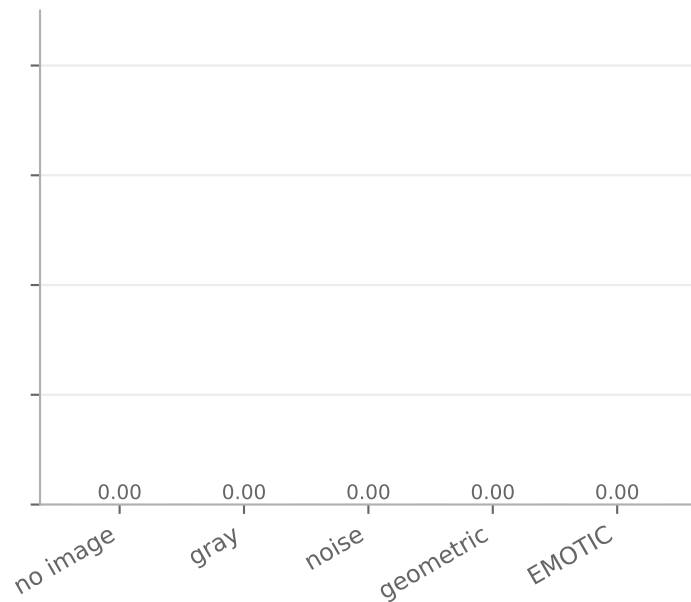
Gemma-4-E4B



Qwen3-VL-2B



Qwen3-VL-4B



Static-image-null control, n=20, full-answer scorer. Non-affective images raise refusal -> the driver is image presence.